



وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بَعْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَاءُ بَعْضٍ يَأْمُرُونَ
بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَيَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَيُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَيُؤْتُونَ
الزَّكَاةَ وَيُطِيعُونَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ...
وَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ:
اسْتَوُوا وَلَا تَخْتَلِفُوا، فَتَخْتَلِفَ قُلُوبُكُمْ.

THE MOSQUE AND SOCIAL LIFE

Dear Muslims!

Mosques are sacred places that embody our brotherhood, symbolize our independence, and reflect our faith in daily life. They bring believers together around the same faith and ideals and direct them toward the same qiblah. Every mosque is a compass that guides us toward the right path, a symbol of tawhid, and a center of unity. It is a place of fellowship and affection that strengthens our unity and solidarity and brings our hearts closer together.

Dear Believers!

In Islamic civilization, mosques have never been merely places of prayer; rather, they have stood at the very heart of life. Our cities developed around mosques, while madrasahs, libraries, marketplaces, inns, bathhouses, and charitable foundations served humanity in their vicinity. The divine command of Allah the Almighty, “**The believers, both men and women, are guardians of one another. They encourage good and forbid evil, establish prayer and pay alms-tax, and obey Allah and His Messenger...**”¹ began in the mosques and permeated every sphere of social life. The joy of weddings was shared beside mosques; the sorrow of funerals was eased in mosques; the hopes of the lonely and the needy blossomed around mosques; and orphans and those without support found protection in them.

Dear Brothers and Sisters!

Regrettably, rapid urbanization, growing attachment to worldly concerns, and individualism today are causing the values represented by mosques to be forgotten. This situation creates distance between hearts that share the same faith, weakens social bonds, and leaves people isolated. Yet our mosques are among the foremost places that can bring us peace and tranquility and strengthen our bonds of brotherhood. Indeed, the Prophet Muhammad (saw) addressed the believers who gathered in the mosque for prayer as follows: “**Keep your rows straight and do not stand apart, lest your hearts become divided as well.**”²

Honorable Believers!

Every year, we observe the first week of October as “Mosques and Religious Officials Week.” This year, in order to raise awareness and revive the historical role of our mosques, we will mark the week under the theme “**The Mosque and Social Life.**” Through the programs to be organized by our mufti offices and religious officials, we will contribute to further strengthening the connection between our mosques and social life. We will strive to make our mosques vibrant centers of social life, where our children develop regular habits of worship, our young people form religious study circles, our elders come together in their courtyards for friendly conversation, and, in short, families experience the joy of being together.

Dear Muslims!

We pray for Allah’s mercy and forgiveness upon our religious officials who have contributed to the spiritual development of our nation from the past to the present, upon the benefactors who contributed to the construction of our mosques, and upon the members of our congregations who have passed on to the Hereafter. We also pray for health and well-being for those who are still with us.

¹ Tawbah, 9/71.

² Muslim, Salat, 122.

